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Service Quality from the Service User's Perspective: A Qualitative Study on Service Quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles

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Abstract: Service quality is a key determinant of organizational success, particularly in public institutions that provide technical services. This study aims to describe the service quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles from the perspective of service users and to identify the factors that shape their perceptions. Prior studies on service quality have predominantly relied on quantitative satisfaction indices, which have not fully captured users' lived experiences, expectations, and complaints, revealing a gap that this study addresses. A descriptive qualitative approach was employed, involving five purposively selected informants: the head of the institution, a service officer, and three service users. Data were collected through in-depth interviews, observation, and documentation, then analyzed using the Miles, Huberman, and Saldaña interactive model. The findings show that service quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles is generally rated favorably across the five service quality dimensions of tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy, with facilities and staff competence viewed positively. However, information clarity, certainty of completion time, and proactive communication remain areas requiring improvement. The novelty of this study lies in positioning service users as the primary source for evaluating a technical public service through direct qualitative inquiry rather than aggregate satisfaction scores.

Keywords: service quality, public service, service users, service user perspective, Bandung Center for Textiles

Abstrak: Kualitas pelayanan merupakan faktor penting dalam keberhasilan organisasi, khususnya institusi publik yang memberikan layanan teknis. Penelitian ini bertujuan untuk mendeskripsikan kualitas pelayanan di Balai Besar Tekstil Bandung berdasarkan perspektif pengguna layanan serta mengidentifikasi faktor-faktor yang memengaruhi persepsi pengguna. Kajian kualitas pelayanan selama ini banyak menggunakan pendekatan kuantitatif berbasis skor kepuasan yang belum sepenuhnya menggambarkan pengalaman, persepsi, dan harapan pengguna secara mendalam, sehingga penelitian ini menggunakan pendekatan kualitatif deskriptif untuk mengisi kesenjangan tersebut. Informan penelitian berjumlah 5 orang, dipilih menggunakan teknik purposive sampling, terdiri dari kepala balai, petugas pelayanan, dan tiga pengguna layanan. Data dikumpulkan melalui wawancara mendalam, observasi, dan dokumentasi, kemudian dianalisis menggunakan model interaktif Miles,

Huberman, dan Saldaña. Hasil penelitian menunjukkan bahwa kualitas pelayanan di Balai Besar Tekstil Bandung secara umum telah berjalan baik berdasarkan lima dimensi kualitas pelayanan, yaitu bukti fisik (tangible), keandalan (reliability), daya tanggap (responsiveness), jaminan (assurance), dan empati (empathy). Namun demikian, aspek kejelasan informasi, kepastian waktu penyelesaian layanan, dan komunikasi proaktif masih perlu ditingkatkan. Kebaruan penelitian ini terletak pada penempatan pengguna layanan sebagai sumber utama penilaian kualitas layanan teknis publik melalui pendekatan kualitatif langsung, bukan sekadar skor kepuasan agregat.

Kata Kunci: kualitas pelayanan, pelayanan publik, pengguna layanan, perspektif pengguna layanan, Balai Besar Tekstil Bandung

INTRODUCTION

Service quality is one of the key aspects determining the success of an organization, whether in business, service-oriented institutions, or public service institutions. Quality service is an important benchmark because it is directly related to the satisfaction, trust, and loyalty of service users toward an institution. In the context of service, users do not evaluate only the final outcome of the service received, but also the entire service process they experience, from the ease of obtaining information and clarity of procedures to timeliness, staff attitude, comfort of facilities, and the institution's ability to fulfill their needs. Service quality therefore cannot be understood merely as compliance with administrative procedures, but also as the real experience felt by users when interacting with the service-providing institution. The better the experience of service users, the greater the opportunity for the institution to build a positive image and strengthen user trust.

In service delivery, service users hold a very important position because they are the party who directly feels, evaluates, and interprets the service provided. Every user has expectations for fast, accurate, clear, friendly, and easily accessible service that meets their needs. When the service received meets or exceeds these expectations, users tend to feel satisfied and to trust the institution; conversely, an unmet expectation can lead to dissatisfaction, complaints, and even a decline in trust. Service quality therefore needs to be examined not only from the service provider's perspective, but also from the perspective of the users who directly experience the service process.

The Bandung Center for Textiles (Balai Besar Tekstil Bandung) is a technical service institution that plays a strategic role in supporting the needs of the textile and textile-product industry. The institution provides testing, standardization, certification, technical consultation, and other services related to improving the quality and competitiveness of the textile industry. Given the technical nature of these services and their direct relation to user needs, service quality is a critical factor in building trust, satisfaction, and loyalty among service users.

Table 1. Service User Satisfaction Data at the Bandung Center for Textiles, 2025

No	Quarter	Evaluated Service Category	Satisfaction Level	Change	Remarks
1	Q I	Service information, administration, testing, staff response, facilities	94.29%	-	Good
2	Q II	Service information, administration, testing, staff response, facilities	94.57%	0.28%	Very good
3	Q III	Service information, administration, testing, staff response, facilities	92.97%	-(1.6%)	Very good
4	Q IV	Service information, administration, testing, staff response, facilities	96.58%	3.61%	Very good

Source: Processed data, 2025

Based on Table 1, which presents preliminary data on service user satisfaction at the Bandung Center for Textiles for the period of January to December 2025, the satisfaction score was derived from an assessment of several service categories: service information, service administration, testing/technical services, staff responsiveness, and service facilities. These categories were selected because they are directly related to the user experience throughout the service process, from obtaining information and submitting a service request to interacting with staff, waiting for the process, and receiving the results.

The data show that the level of user satisfaction fluctuated throughout 2025, with a notable decline of 1.6% recorded in the third quarter. This condition indicates that the service quality perceived by users has not fully and consistently improved, and it forms the empirical basis for conducting a more in-depth study on service quality from the perspective of service users at the Bandung Center for Textiles.

The core problem of this study lies in the importance of understanding how service users evaluate the quality of the service provided by the Bandung Center for Textiles. As users, they naturally have expectations regarding ease of obtaining information, clarity of procedures, timeliness of completion, accuracy of results, staff attitude, responsiveness to questions or complaints, and certainty of the service provided. In practice, however, a gap often exists between the service standards established by the institution and the actual experience of service users. Studies on service quality have mostly relied on quantitative approaches that measure satisfaction through numerical scores or specific indicators; while such approaches describe the general level of satisfaction, they have not been able to fully explain users' experiences, perceptions, complaints, and expectations in depth. A qualitative approach is therefore needed to explore users' experiences more deeply and to understand service quality from their direct perspective.

Several specific issues can be identified as background to this study. First, the level of user satisfaction fluctuated during 2025, with a 1.60% decline recorded in the third quarter, indicating that service quality has not been consistently able to meet user expectations. Second, information regarding the service flow, requirements, and estimated completion time—both physical and digital—remains unclear for new users, and staff tend to use technical terms without adequate simplification for non-technical users. Third, in terms of reliability, uncertainty remains regarding the duration and timeliness of laboratory testing and technical services. Fourth, in terms of responsiveness, staff tend to be passive in providing proactive updates on the progress of ongoing services. Fifth, a gap exists between the institution's formal operational standards (SOPs) and the actual experience of users in the field. Sixth, in terms of empathy, the handling of special needs, administrative obstacles, and user complaints still tends to prioritize procedural compliance over flexible attentiveness.

Theoretically, this study adopts the concept of service quality proposed by Slamet and Sulistiyowati (2022), who explain that service quality can be understood through five main dimensions: tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy. These five dimensions remain widely used as a framework in service quality research across various sectors because they comprehensively capture users' perceptions of service quality.

This view is reinforced by several recent studies examining service quality from the user's perspective in public and technical laboratory institutions. Fitriana (2022) found that the dimensions of tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy have a positive effect on customer satisfaction, both partially and simultaneously, indicating that service quality is not determined by a single aspect but by a combination of the institution's ability to provide adequate facilities.

Kurniawan and Dwimawanti (2021), in the context of a quality-certification institution, similarly emphasized that the five dimensions of service quality are closely related to user satisfaction, showing that users evaluate service quality through their direct experience when

interacting with the service provider. This indicates that good service is not solely about the availability of facilities, but also about consistency of service delivery.

A study specifically examining testing-laboratory services by Setyowati et al. (2020) also found that tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy had a positive and significant effect on customer satisfaction within an official testing institution, suggesting that service quality must be understood as a holistic experience rather than merely as the final outcome of the service.

Furthermore, Fathurohman et al. (2023) explained that the quality of testing-laboratory services can be evaluated using the SERVQUAL method, comprising the five dimensions of tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy. Their findings showed that a gap remained between customer expectations and perceptions across all dimensions, indicating the need for continuous service quality improvement and reinforcing the notion that users tend to evaluate service based on the real experience they feel during a technical testing process.

According to Tjiptono (2022), service quality is an organization's effort to fulfill customer needs and expectations through the delivery of quality service, and users' experience during service delivery is closely related to customer satisfaction and loyalty (Nadifa et al., 2022).

Based on the problems outlined above, this study aims to describe the service quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles from the perspective of service users. This study seeks to understand users' experiences during service delivery using Tjiptono's service quality dimensions: tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy.

The novelty of this study lies in its focus on positioning service users as the primary source for evaluating the service quality of the Bandung Center for Textiles through a qualitative approach. Rather than measuring service quality solely on the basis of satisfaction scores or formal indicators, this study explores in depth the experiences, perceptions, complaints, and expectations of service users. In addition, this study addresses a service context that differs from general public services: technical services such as testing, standardization, certification, and consultation require accuracy, clarity, trust, and effective communication between the institution and its users. This study is therefore expected to contribute theoretically to the development of service quality research, and practically to the Bandung Center for Textiles in improving service delivery that is more responsive, transparent, professional, and aligned with the needs of service users.

METHODS

This study employed a descriptive qualitative approach, chosen because the research aims to describe and understand service quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles based on the experience of service users. According to Sugiyono (2020), qualitative research is used to examine a phenomenon in depth and is exploratory, interpretive, interactive, and constructive in nature, with the researcher serving as the primary instrument of data collection. This is supported by Wicaksono and Amrullah (2026), who note that data analysis was carried out using the Miles, Huberman, and Saldāna model, comprising data reduction, data display, and conclusion drawing. Data reduction was carried out by selecting, categorizing, and simplifying the data obtained from interviews, observation, and documentation according to the research focus. The data were then presented in narrative form based on Tjiptono's five dimensions of service quality—tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy. The final stage involved continuous conclusion drawing and verification throughout the research process in order to obtain valid findings that correspond to actual field conditions.

The descriptive approach was used to explain the facts and conditions of the service as felt by service users, rather than to test hypotheses or measure relationships between variables. A descriptive qualitative approach is appropriate given that the data examined

consist of users' experiences, opinions, perceptions, complaints, and expectations. Natalie and Deanna (2021) explain that in-depth interviews in qualitative research are conducted through open-ended questions that allow the researcher to explore informants' experiences, views, and underlying reasoning in greater depth.

This study was conducted at the Bandung Center for Textiles. The research informants were service users who had received services such as information, administrative, testing/technical, and other supporting services. Informants were selected using a purposive sampling technique, based on the consideration that they had direct experience receiving the service. Five informants participated in this study: the head of the Bandung Center for Textiles, one service officer, and three service users. The head of the institution was selected due to their authority over service delivery, the service officer was selected due to their direct interaction with service users, and the service users were selected because they had direct experience receiving the service and could therefore provide information on service quality based on their lived experience.

Data were collected through interviews, observation, and documentation. Interviews were used to explore users' experiences and perceptions of service quality; observation was used to examine service conditions, facilities, service flow, and the interaction between staff and service users; and documentation was used to obtain supporting data, such as 2025 user satisfaction data, types of service, service standards, and other relevant documents.

Table 2. Data Types, Sources, Instruments, and Benefits Used in This Study

Data Type / Source	Instrument	Data Form	Benefit
SECONDARY			
Bandung Center for Textiles		• User satisfaction score recap 2025 (Q I – Q IV)	To support the background of the
	Documentation & Literature Study	• Institutional service standards & SOPs • Scientific journals & theoretical books (Tjiptono, Sugiyono, etc.)	& problem, map satisfaction fluctuations, and strengthen the theoretical framework and discussion.
PRIMARY			
Service Users (Consumers) of the Bandung Center for Textiles		• Transcripts and narratives of interview results on the 5 dimensions of service quality (tangibles, responsiveness, empathy)	To explore users' perceptions, real experiences, obstacles, reliability, and expectations in assurance, depth in order to answer the research problem.
	Observation	• Field notes on the condition of physical facilities, availability of information media, service flow, and staff interaction	To directly confirm field conditions and strengthen the results and discussion regarding tangibles and responsiveness.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Ease of Understanding Technical Information

Although the credibility of testing services is generally recognized as high, the delivery of information remains an important concern. Service users without a technical background in textiles often find it difficult to understand technical terms, procedures, and requirements. This indicates the need to simplify the delivery of information and technical explanations so that they are more concise, easier to understand, and transparent for all types of users.

Certainty of Time and Service Delays

The reliability of the service, particularly regarding timeliness of completion, frequently faces challenges. In several cases, technical and laboratory testing services require a considerable amount of time, often exceeding the estimated duration or experiencing

delays. This condition creates the perception that the service has not been fully consistent in providing certainty regarding completion time for users who require fast results.

Quality and Proactivity of Communication

The communication pattern between staff and service users is considered not yet fully proactive. Although staff are friendly and cooperative when contacted, the delivery of status updates or progress information on ongoing technical services tends to be passive. Service users often have to take the initiative to inquire about the progress of their service themselves, as no notification system or proactive communication channel is yet available from the institution.

Service Quality in the Tangibles Dimension

The tangibles dimension relates to the condition of facilities and infrastructure, the service space, supporting facilities, the availability of information, and staff appearance that can be directly observed by service users. Based on the findings, service users generally rated the physical condition of services at the Bandung Center for Textiles as fairly good, reflected in the availability of a service area, service counters, seating facilities, information boards, and a relatively well-organized service environment. Some users stated that the service area was comfortable, particularly due to the availability of a waiting area and supporting facilities. The presence of staff at the service counter was also considered helpful for obtaining initial information about the type of service, application procedures, and administrative requirements. In addition, the neat and professional appearance of staff created the impression that the institution strives to maintain a positive service image.

Based on an interview with the Head of the Bandung Center for Textiles, improving service facilities and infrastructure is one of the priorities in enhancing service quality; facilities are continuously improved to provide comfort for users.

"We strive to provide comfortable service facilities and continuously make improvements according to users' needs. In addition to physical facilities, we are also developing digital information media so that the public can more easily access information."

Following the interview with the Head of the institution, the researcher interviewed the service officer and the service users.

"We always ensure that the service area is clean, comfortable, and that all facilities can be used properly. If a user has difficulty finding information, we try to help directly. (Service officer)"

"In my opinion, the service area is already comfortable, and the seating is adequate. It's just that the information about the service flow is still a bit confusing for first-time visitors. (Service user 1)"

"The service facilities are quite complete, and the waiting room is comfortable. However, I think the information board regarding the service stages still needs to be made simpler so it is easier to understand. (Service user 2)"

"I feel that the service environment is clean and the staff are easy to find. However, when I first came, I still had to ask staff about the service flow because the available information was not clear enough. (Service user 3)"

Based on the interviews with the Head of the institution, the service officer, and the three service users, it can be concluded that the physical facility conditions at the Bandung Center for Textiles have generally provided comfort for service users. All informants shared relatively similar views regarding the cleanliness of the service area, the availability of supporting facilities, and the professional appearance of staff. Nevertheless, the three service users also noted that information media regarding the service flow still needs to be simplified,

particularly for new users. This finding indicates that the quality of tangibles is not only determined by the completeness of facilities and infrastructure, but also by the ease with which users can obtain service information.

Service Quality in the Reliability Dimension

The reliability dimension relates to the institution's ability to deliver services accurately, consistently, and in accordance with its service commitments. In the context of the Bandung Center for Textiles, reliability is particularly important because the services provided—laboratory testing, consultation, and certification—are technical in nature and demand precision and certainty of results. Based on the findings, users generally rated the institution as having a fairly good level of reliability, stating that the service process runs according to procedure and that staff are able to direct users according to their needs. In testing and administrative services, users considered the procedures relatively clear and the results trustworthy, reflected in staff's ability to provide information about service requirements, process stages, and required follow-up actions. In technical services, reliability is measured not only by the speed of service but also by the accuracy of results, compliance with procedures, and assurance that the service is carried out professionally. Nevertheless, several users still raised concerns regarding the timeliness of service completion.

The Head of the institution explained that all services are carried out in accordance with SOPs and laboratory quality standards.

“All of our services refer to SOPs and laboratory quality standards, so that testing results are credible and can be trusted by service users. (Head of the institution)”

“We provide services according to the applicable procedures. If any requirements are incomplete, we inform users immediately so that the service process is not hindered. (Service officer)”

“I trust the testing results because it is indeed a referral laboratory. It's just that the process sometimes takes longer than expected. (Service user 1)”

“I feel the testing results provided are quite accurate and trustworthy. However, I hope the estimated completion time can be more certain. (Service user 2)”

“During my use of the service, I have never experienced an incorrect result; it's just that the process is sometimes longer than expected. (Service user 3)”

Based on the interviews with all informants, the reliability of services at the Bandung Center for Textiles is rated as good because the entire process follows SOPs and the results are trusted by users. However, the three service users shared the view that certainty of completion time still needs improvement, so that reliability is reflected not only in the accuracy of results but also in the timeliness of service completion.

Service Quality in the Responsiveness Dimension

The responsiveness dimension relates to staff's willingness and speed in assisting users, providing information, answering questions, and handling needs or complaints that arise during the service process. It is an important aspect of service quality because it greatly affects users' comfort when interacting with the institution. The findings show that users generally rated the staff of the Bandung Center for Textiles as fairly responsive: staff were considered attentive in receiving users, explaining service procedures, and providing guidance on required documents. Staff's communicative and easily accessible attitude was also appreciated as a form of responsiveness. Users who had used the service several times tended to feel that staff already understood their needs and were able to provide sufficiently clear explanations.

Based on the interview with the Head of the institution, all staff are directed to provide fast responses to users' needs.

"We always remind staff to be responsive to every question or complaint from users, because good communication greatly determines customer satisfaction. (Head of the institution)"

"If there is a question, we try to answer as quickly as possible. When the queue is busy, responses may be a bit slower, but we still try our best. (Service officer)"

"The staff are friendly; when I arrived, I was directly directed to the appropriate counter. If any requirements were incomplete, the staff explained patiently so I understood the process I needed to follow. (Service user 1)"

"Staff respond quickly when I ask directly, but I hope there could be automatic information about the progress of the service. (Service user 2)"

"If I come in person, the service is fast; it's just that while waiting for results, I have to contact the staff first. (Service user 3)"

The interview findings show that all informants rated staff as having good responsiveness in providing direct service. However, users expect more proactive communication regarding the progress of the service process so that they do not always need to contact staff for information.

Service Quality in the Assurance Dimension

The assurance dimension relates to staff's knowledge, competence, courtesy, and ability to build users' trust in the service provided. In technical services such as textile testing, assurance plays a very important role because users need not only the service outcome but also confidence that the process is carried out by competent and trustworthy staff. Based on the findings, users generally rated the staff of the institution as capable of instilling trust, reflected in staff's ability to explain service procedures, provide convincing technical information, and display polite and professional conduct.

The Head of the institution stated that staff competence is continuously improved through various training programs.

"Staff competence is one of the keys to successful service. We continuously improve both technical and communication skills so that users feel confident in the service provided. (Head of the institution)"

"We attend regular training so that we are able to explain service procedures and provide information in accordance with the applicable provisions. (Service officer)"

"The staff explained things well, so I feel confident using the service here. (Service user 1)"

"I trust the laboratory results because the staff appear to master their work. (Service user 2)"

"The staff's explanation was quite clear, so I feel confident using the service at the Bandung Center for Textiles. (Service user 3)"

Based on the interviews with all informants, staff competence is the main factor that builds users' trust. The Head of the institution explained that competence is continuously improved through training, staff confirmed the implementation of such training, and users stated that they feel confident in the quality of service provided.

Service Quality in the Empathy Dimension

The empathy dimension relates to staff's attentiveness, care, friendliness, and ability to understand each user's individual needs. In public service, empathy is important because users need not only fast and accurate service but also to be treated well and valued. Based on

the findings, users generally rated staff of the institution as friendly and polite, willing to listen to questions, provide guidance, and help when users experienced difficulty understanding procedures. This attitude created a positive impression and made users feel more comfortable during the service process. Some users also noted that staff's empathy was reflected in their willingness to re-explain information, help check document completeness, or adjust their communication style to users' needs. In technical services, this attentiveness matters because not all users share the same level of understanding of terms, procedures, or service flow.

The Head of the institution emphasized that all staff are expected to provide friendly service oriented toward users' needs.

"We emphasize to all staff that they should not only follow procedures but also understand users' needs and provide service with a friendly attitude that respects every customer. (Head of the institution)"

"We try to serve all users politely and help them when they experience difficulty completing requirements. (Service officer)"

"The staff were patient enough in explaining when I did not yet understand the procedure. (Service user 1)"

"The staff were quite friendly and did not discriminate between users. (Service user 2)"

"I felt served politely, and when some requirements were incomplete, the staff explained patiently. (Service user 3)"

Based on the interviews with all informants, the empathy dimension has been well implemented through staff's friendly, polite attitude and willingness to help users. Nevertheless, users still expect more personal attention, particularly when facing administrative obstacles or requiring further explanation of the service process.

Service Quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles from the Perspective of Service Users

The findings show that service quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles is generally rated as good by service users. This assessment is based on users' experience throughout the entire service process, from obtaining information and interacting with staff to receiving the service outcome, indicating that service quality is determined not only by successful completion of the service but also by the overall process as perceived by users.

Users gave positive assessments of the condition of service facilities, staff competence, and the friendly attitude shown in service delivery. However, the study also found several aspects that still require improvement: the clarity of service information, certainty of completion time, more proactive communication, simplification of technical information, and enhanced personal service. These findings indicate that users' perceptions of service quality are shaped by their real experience during the service process, and that service quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles is influenced not only by compliance with operational standards but also by the organization's ability to fully meet users' expectations.

Analysis of Findings Based on Tjiptono's Service Quality Dimensions

The findings show that the tangibles dimension has created a favorable impression among users: facilities were rated as clean, well-organized, and reasonably comfortable, and staff's neat appearance together with the availability of a waiting area and service counters created a professional impression of the institution. Nevertheless, some users still experienced difficulty understanding information about procedures, requirements, and service flow, particularly first-time users. This indicates that the tangibles dimension is not limited to the condition of the building or facilities, but also encompasses the provision of information media that is easy for the public to understand.

This finding is consistent with Tjiptono's (2022) theory, which explains that the tangibles dimension encompasses all physical evidence perceivable by users, including service facilities, equipment, staff appearance, and communication media. Clear information provision is therefore an important part of service quality; the tangibles dimension in public service encompasses both physical aspects and ease of access to information, and together these shape users' positive perceptions. This finding is also consistent with Fitriana (2022), who found that service facilities and ease of obtaining information influence user satisfaction: the easier it is for users to understand the service process, the higher their perception of the quality of service provided.

The reliability dimension shows that users rated the institution as capable of delivering services according to procedure and producing accurate results; users' trust in laboratory testing results is one indicator of a good level of reliability. However, certainty of completion time remains a concern, as several informants noted that the completion time for technical services sometimes exceeds estimates, which affects their perception of service quality. According to Tjiptono (2022), reliability is an organization's ability to deliver services accurately, consistently, and in accordance with commitments made to customers, so timeliness is an important part of shaping the perception of reliability. This finding also supports Fathurohman et al. (2023), who found a gap between users' expectations and the completion time of laboratory services, indicating that even when the quality of the service outcome is good, certainty of service time remains a factor that strongly influences user satisfaction.

The findings show that staff have demonstrated good responsiveness, providing information, assisting with administrative processes, and answering users' questions politely and communicatively. Nevertheless, communication regarding the progress of the service process has not yet been carried out proactively, as most users stated that they had to contact staff themselves to find out the progress of their service. According to Tjiptono (2022), the responsiveness dimension reflects not only staff's willingness to help customers but also the organization's ability to deliver fast and responsive service to users' needs. This is in line with Herianto et al. (2024), who stated that fast and responsive communication is an important factor in improving the quality of public services; the development of a digital information system capable of providing automatic notifications regarding service status could therefore be a strategy for improving service quality.

The findings show that staff competence is the main factor building users' trust. Users feel confident because staff are able to explain service procedures well and the results provided have a high level of credibility. Nevertheless, some users hope that technical information can be delivered using simpler language that is easier for the public to understand, especially those without a technical background.

The empathy dimension shows that staff have made efforts to provide friendly, polite service that respects each user, providing a positive experience during the service process. Nevertheless, users still expect more personal attention, particularly when facing administrative obstacles or requiring additional information about a service in progress. According to Tjiptono (2022), empathy is an organization's ability to provide individualized attention to each customer according to their respective needs; service oriented toward users' needs increases satisfaction and builds a stronger relationship between the service provider and the user. This finding supports Nadifa et al. (2022), who stated that a caring, friendly, and attentive staff attitude is an important factor in increasing user satisfaction and loyalty.

Consistency of Findings with Theory and Prior Research

The findings of this study are consistent with Tjiptono's concept of service quality, which emphasizes that service quality is formed by five main dimensions—tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy. In this study, these five dimensions

proved to be the basis for users' assessment of the service provided by the Bandung Center for Textiles. This finding is also consistent with Hardiyansyah (2020), who stated that public service quality is influenced by a combination of facility aspects, service accuracy, staff responsiveness, sense of security, and attentiveness to users. At the Bandung Center for Textiles, users did not evaluate a single aspect alone, but rather the entirety of the service experience they directly felt.

In addition, this finding is consistent with Herianto et al. (2024), who found that public service quality is influenced by users' direct experience throughout the service process—an experience shaped by their assessment of tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy provided by the service organizer.

This study shows that users of the Bandung Center for Textiles place great importance on procedural clarity, service certainty, and staff's ability to provide explanations. This finding is also consistent with Rifka Alkhilyatul Ma'rifat et al. (2024), who found that the quality of laboratory services has a significant relationship with user satisfaction, with communication, reliability, tangibles, and staff friendliness being important factors shaping user satisfaction. In the context of the Bandung Center for Textiles, this finding reinforces the notion that the quality of interaction between staff and users plays an important role in shaping a positive service experience, reflected in the importance of technical service accuracy, trust in service outcomes, and the quality of staff–user interaction.

Overall, the findings show that the tangibles dimension at the Bandung Center for Textiles has performed well, although improvements are still needed in the delivery of service information so that it is more easily understood by all users. The principal novelty identified by this study is that service quality perception among users of a technical public institution is shaped less by facility completeness or procedural compliance alone, and more by the transparency and timeliness of communication throughout the service process—an aspect that distinguishes a merely adequate service from one perceived as genuinely trustworthy.

Factors Influencing Service Users' Perceptions of Service Quality

Based on the findings, service users' perceptions of service quality are influenced by five main factors: the clarity of service information, certainty of completion time, staff communication ability, staff attitude in delivering service, and the condition of service facilities. These five factors are interrelated in shaping users' experience throughout the service process. This indicates that service quality cannot be assessed solely on the basis of successful completion, but is also influenced by users' experience at every stage of the process—the better the experience felt by users, the higher their perception of the institution's service quality.

Implications of the Findings for Service Improvement

This study implies that efforts to improve service quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles need to be carried out comprehensively across all five service quality dimensions. In terms of tangibles, the institution needs to strengthen its service information system, clarify the service flow, and improve the comfort of supporting facilities. In terms of reliability, efforts are needed to maintain consistency in service timeliness and to provide more certain information regarding estimated completion times. In terms of responsiveness, the institution needs to improve response speed and proactive communication with users, particularly regarding service progress and follow-up on questions or complaints. In terms of assurance, it is important to continuously maintain staff competence and strengthen technical communication skills so that users feel more confident and understand the service they receive. Meanwhile, in terms of empathy, the institution needs to continue fostering a friendly, communicative service culture oriented toward users' needs.

CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Conclusion

Based on the findings, the service quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles from the perspective of service users is generally rated as good. This is reflected in users' assessment of the reasonably adequate service facilities, the institution's ability to provide accurate and trustworthy services, sufficiently good staff responsiveness, a sense of security and confidence in staff competence, and a friendly and attentive service attitude. Nevertheless, the findings also indicate that several aspects still require improvement, including the clarity of service information, certainty of completion time, proactive communication with users, simplification of technical explanations, and strengthening of more personal and empathetic service. Continuous improvement of service quality at the Bandung Center for Textiles therefore needs to be carried out with close attention to the experiences and expectations of service users.

Limitations

This study has several limitations. First, it was conducted with a small number of informants (five individuals) at a single institution, so the findings cannot yet be generalized to other technical public service institutions or regions. Second, the study relied primarily on a descriptive qualitative approach without complementary quantitative measurement, so the magnitude of the relationship between each service quality dimension and user satisfaction could not be statistically determined. Third, data collection was carried out within a limited period, so the findings may not fully capture seasonal or long-term changes in service quality perception. The findings should therefore be interpreted within the scope and context of this study.

Recommendations

For the Bandung Center for Textiles, it is recommended to improve the clarity of service information by simplifying the flow, requirements, and procedures through information media that are easy for all users to understand; to improve the certainty of service completion time in accordance with service standards while providing information whenever delays occur; and to develop a more proactive communication system, such as automatic notifications regarding service status through digital media. For future research, it is recommended to increase the number and variety of informants in order to obtain more comprehensive data on service quality, to employ a mixed-methods or quantitative approach to complement the findings of this qualitative study, and to examine other factors that may influence service quality, such as service digitalization, human resource competence, organizational culture, and public service innovation.

Author Contributions

All authors made significant contributions to this study. These contributions included research conceptualization, development of the theoretical framework, data collection, data analysis, interpretation of results, manuscript preparation, scholarly revision, and final approval of the manuscript for publication. All authors confirm that they have read and approved the final version of the article.

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